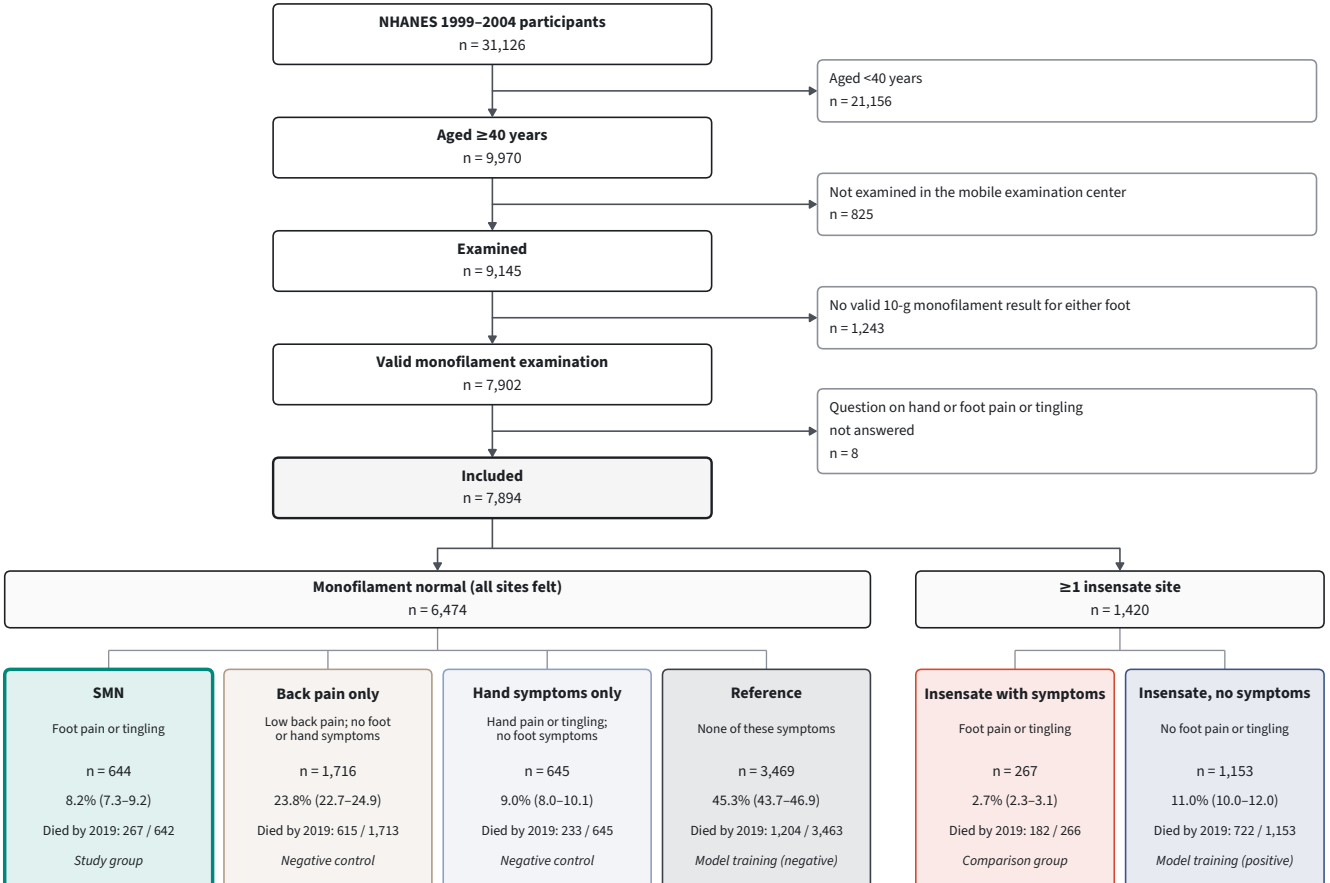
NHANES 1999–2004 participants
n = 31,126
Aged <40 years
n = 21,156
Aged ≥40 years
n = 9,970
Not examined in the mobile examination center
n = 825
Examined
n = 9,145
No valid 10-g monofilament result for either foot
n = 1,243
Valid monofilament examination
n = 7,902
Question on hand or foot pain or tingling not answered
n = 8
Included
n = 7,894
Monofilament normal (all sites felt)
n = 6,474
≥1 insensate site
n = 1,420
SMN
Foot pain or tingling
n = 644
8.2% (7.3–9.2)
Died by 2019: 267 / 642
Study group
Back pain only
Low back pain; no foot or hand symptoms
n = 1,716
23.8% (22.7–24.9)
Died by 2019: 615 / 1,713
Negative control
Hand symptoms only
Hand pain or tingling; no foot symptoms
n = 645
9.0% (8.0–10.1)
Died by 2019: 233 / 645
Negative control
Reference
None of these symptoms
n = 3,469
45.3% (43.7–46.9)
Died by 2019: 1,204 / 3,463
Model training (negative)
Insensate with symptoms
Foot pain or tingling
n = 267
2.7% (2.3–3.1)
Died by 2019: 182 / 266
Comparison group
Insensate, no symptoms
No foot pain or tingling
n = 1,153
11.0% (10.0–12.0)
Died by 2019: 722 / 1,153
Model training (positive)